

Erse ERBAY

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PROFILE

Product- and delivery-focused professional with a Software Engineering background and 4+ years of experience spanning feature delivery on globally released products, business intelligence, and R&D process improvement. Combines requirements engineering, stakeholder management, and data-informed decision support with hands-on delivery coordination, translating business needs into prioritized, deliverable solutions for cross-functional teams.

Completing an MSc in Global Technology and Innovation Management at TU Hamburg (graduation 10/2026); master's thesis on organizations' strategic response to AI at the business model level.

Work experience in Germany, the UK, the USA, and Turkey.

WORK EXPERIENCE

10.2024 – 10.2025

R&D Change Management Werkstudent

Olympus Corporation · Hamburg, Germany

- Built capability management and initiative-tracking tools to improve visibility and reporting transparency for continuous improvement initiatives across the global R&D organization.
- Applied GenAI tools to accelerate improvement-idea evaluation and streamline pre-categorization workflows, reducing early-stage assessment effort for stakeholders.
- Supported development of a global Control Tower framework for Lean, Agile, and Six Sigma initiatives, including KPI structure definition and governance alignment.
- Documented and integrated Lean, Agile, and DFSS methodologies within the R&D Center of Development Excellence.

01.2024 – 09.2024

IT Business Analyst

CFN Kimya · Turkey

- Delivered 7 Power BI dashboards covering 50 KPIs for 40 business users across 5 departments, reducing manual reporting effort by 40 hours/week.
- Gathered and analyzed business requirements through stakeholder interviews and process mapping; translated them into specifications for reporting automation and system improvements delivered with IT teams.

01.2021 – 10.2023

Freelance Projects & Independent Ventures

Self-employed · Turkey

- Ran a small technology services business: hardware specification, builds, troubleshooting, and ongoing technical support for private clients.
- Continued independent technical study in software development and data analytics alongside client work.

01.2019 – 03.2020

Technical Designer - Feature Delivery

Sumo Digital · Sheffield, United Kingdom

- Defined and scoped feature requirements in collaboration with engineering, art, and QA teams, translating high-level design intent into implementable tasks with clear acceptance criteria.
- Conducted iterative user research to gather structured feedback, identify pain points, and prioritize improvements, feeding findings directly into the feature backlog.
- Managed delivery of multiple features simultaneously, balancing quality, constraints, and timelines across a cross-functional team.

05.2016 – 05.2017 **Associate Technical Designer**

Sledgehammer Games · California, USA - Call of Duty: WWII

- Coordinated across engineering, design, and production disciplines on a globally released product, aligning technical constraints with experience goals across a large cross-functional studio.
- Translated design specifications into detailed task breakdowns and iteration plans; managed feedback-driven revisions with documented decisions and consistent follow-through.

EDUCATION

10.2024 – 10.2026
(Expected)

MSc Global Technology and Innovation Management

TU Hamburg · Hamburg, Germany

Master’s thesis: “The Strategic Response of Organizations to AI: Assessing Business Model Impact and Identifying New Opportunities for Value Creation and Competitive Positioning” (in progress)

2015 – 2016

Master of Science, Game Design & Production

Full Sail University · Orlando, Florida, USA | **Partial Scholarship**

2010 – 2014

Bachelor of Science, Software Engineering

Izmir University of Economics · Izmir, Turkey | **Full Scholarship**

SKILLS & TOOLS

Product & Analysis

Business Analysis · Requirements Engineering · Product Strategy & Roadmapping · User Research · Feature Prioritization · User Stories & Use Cases · Backlog Management · Data-Driven Decision Making · Business Intelligence · Process Optimization & Digitalization

Practices & Competencies

Agile · Scrum · Kanban · Lean · Design Thinking · Stakeholder Management · Change Management · Process Mapping · Root Cause Analysis · Gap Analysis · OKR/KPI Management · Risk Management · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Digital Transformation

Tools

Jira · Confluence · Microsoft Power BI · SQL · Excel · Miro · GenAI Tools · SAP · Azure · GitHub · REST APIs · JavaScript / Node.js

LANGUAGES

English

C2 – Bilingual (Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency)

Turkish

C2 – Native

German

A2 – Basic (Working towards B1)